GUIDANCE AND COUNSELING MANUAL

Guidance and Testing Center Philosophy, Goals And Objectives

Philosophy

The DSSC Guidance and Testing Center believes that every human organism has an organization of potentialities; able to solve his own problems, capable of making decisions, has dignity, worth and right to pursue his own lifestyle and has needs necessary to maintain and/or enhance his phenomenal self.

Goals

To help in the holistic development of the student's moral, intellectual, social, physical and psychological aspects to maximize his self-directed capabilities and to make his own decisions as a dynamic Filipino citizen.

Specific Objectives

1. To provide quality direct services to clients throughout their stay in the institution specifically on academic, moral, social and career concerns.
2. To coordinate with the faculty, staff, administration, parents and students in the formulation and implementation of appropriate guidance programs.
3. To conduct researches for the growth of the client through standardized psychological testing materials which can broaden the effectiveness of the guidance program.

Essential Elements

The following are the essential elements of Guidance and Counseling (Mendoza, 2003):

1. Process pertains to the series of activities to assist individuals.
2. Development aspect pertains to the aims for the development of the whole person.
3. Guidance is for everyone.
4. Right to free choice is where the individual learner's ability to decide for himself is given primary assistance.
5. Wise decision-making is done with a view of possibilities and potentials to be developed in the future.
6. Realistic appraisal of opportunities around him has to be given due consideration and emphasis. Recognition of individual differences should be practiced.

Scope

Guidance covers three specific areas namely: personal-social, educational and career. These areas refer to:

1. **Personal-Social** includes individual's strengths, needs, values, interests, aptitudes, and accomplishments, health, feelings about themselves and towards others, physical and emotional changes, and sensitivity to the feelings and needs of others in a group;
2. **Educational** includes wide range of educational resources planning, and how education relates to life and career choices;
3. **Career** includes understanding of the concept of career-related terms such as career, occupation, job, and work in planning for the future, effective decision-making skills in life and career planning, exploring occupational alternatives.

As an integral part of education, guidance offers assistance to individuals so that they would make intelligent decisions and adjustments in life.

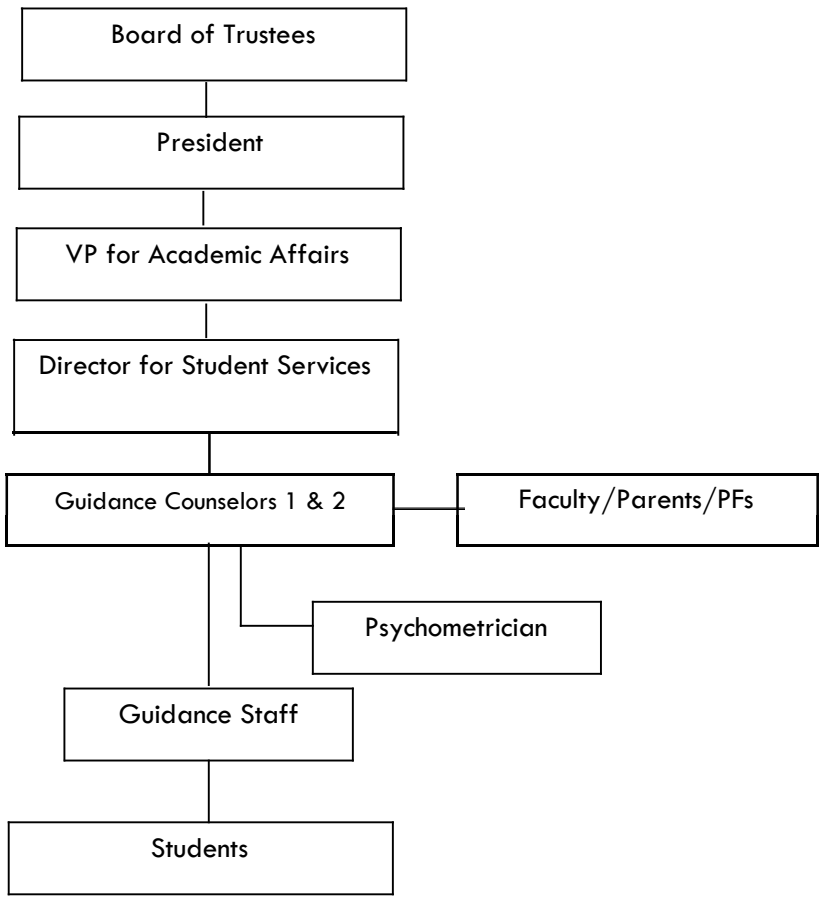
Guiding Principles

The development, establishment, and maintenance of the guidance program are based on certain principles (Gibson and Mitchell, 1991).

1. Guidance is a fundamental and integral part of the educational system. It provides for the holistic development of the students.
2. Education and guidance support and complement each other to maximize students' growth and development.
3. Administrative and faculty understanding and support of the Guidance Program are crucial to its success.
4. Guidance personnel perform specific tasks distinct and separate from teaching and disciplining.
5. Guidance addresses the developmental and adjustment needs of the students.
6. Guidance considers the unique culture and climate of the specific population and environment it serves.
7. Guidance is a continuous process throughout the student's stay in school.
8. Guidance activities are specifically planned and developed to ensure Program effectiveness.
9. Guidance recognizes that every individual has needs that must be attended to.
10. Guidance is committed to equally extend its services regardless of diversities such as age, gender, religion, ethnicity, civil status, disability, etc.
11. All individuals can develop their own insights, have the right and capability to make decisions and plans.
12. Guidance is updated with psychological testing materials such as Aptitude Test, Personality Diagnosis, and IQ tests which will be used to widen the effectiveness of guidance procedures and faculty teaching

The Guidance Personnel

The Structure



The Function

The Director for Student Affairs and Services

The Director for Student Affairs and Services (DSAS) functions as overall administrator, leader, and coordinator of the guidance services in the school. The SAS Director works directly with the guidance counselor of the institution and participates in various committees and consults or refers with the Department Chairpersons, Alumni Association, Referral Agencies and other service units.

Specifically, the SAS Director shall perform the following functions:

1. Directs the planning, implementation, evaluation and development of guidance services.
2. Oversees the implementation of Guidance services to students.
3. Implements functional management information when needed for proper decision-making.
4. Chairs regular meeting/in-service training on staff and faculty to update them of recent development in Guidance and research as well as on administrative issues and problems.
5. Conducts periodic assessment of staff performance to improve services and competency.
6. Coordinates with other programs from within and outside the school to ensure inter-program complementation and efficient maximization of available resources.
7. Submits the annual budget and performance reports.

The Guidance Counselor

The Guidance Counselor is the central and most indispensable figure of the program and a specialist who brings unique knowledge and skills to handle the Program. According to Gibson and Mitchell (2003), the counselor plays five

- major roles called **5 C's**: **Counselor, Coordinator, Consultant, Conductor of Activities, and Change Agent.**
    - As Counselor; helps people overcome obstacles to their personal and educational/professional growth and move toward the maximum development of their potential.
    - As Coordinator; needs to be able to identify tasks that should be done by other persons or an agency and organize everything to facilitate the performance of such tasks by the needed person or agency.
    - As Consultant; acts as an objective party, looking at the situation and suggesting other helpful interventions without necessarily having a direct contact with the identified client whose needs are being addressed.
    - As Conductor of Activities; need to carefully plan and directly conduct certain activities that may promote the client's positive movement in life.
    - As a Change Agent; the counselor must be involved in the process of organizational change, where necessary. The role may involve acting as a catalyzer, process helper, solution giver, resource linker, and stabilizer.

The Guidance Counselor must have thorough familiarity with human growth and development theories and concepts, family development, learning, and motivational theories. One must also have an appropriate understanding and awareness of the concepts that guide professional practice, such as individual, group, and family counseling theories and concepts, career development and decision-making theories. Further, the Guidance Counselor must also have sufficient human experience leading to an understanding of people's goals, ambitions, interests, fears or symptoms. Finally, the Guidance Counselor must have sufficient awareness of oneself – strengths and limitations, values and fears, constantly updating and upgrading one's skills and knowledge and works with professionalism (Gibson and Mitchell, 1991).

The Guidance Counselor shall have the following functions:

1. Formulates a guidance program for students for each school year.
2. Holds regular counseling sessions with students.
3. Plans and implements a program for group guidance.
4. Implements Guidance Services of the College
5. Keep individual records of students are references for guidance work.
6. Coordinates with the Director for Students Services in matters pertaining to students' welfare.
7. Assists teachers in discovering individual differences among students and in meeting their individual needs.
8. Cooperate with co-employees, community agencies, and organizations for the welfare of the students.
9. Maintains strict confidentiality of students' individual records.
10. Performs other duties as deemed necessary.

A School Counselor's Creed
By Steven Yim

I will:

- Listen with my whole being.
- Communicate to every student I meet that each is special and precious in my eyes.
- Encourage and support the students when they feel despair.
- Correct gently and point them in a direction that is true to their own life spirit.
- Parent those who need it and befriend those who have lost faith in adults.
- Keep my promises to them.
- Be there when everyone else loses heart and turns away from them.
- Point their eyes to their own beautiful selves.
- Affirm every creative spark that emanates from their mouths and their actions.
- Believe in students' dreams and persist in assisting them to imagine what some say is impossible.
- See miracles that they perform in everyday tasks at home and at school.
- Remind the students that they can get along with each other no matter what the problem.
- Give the students I meet each day a chance to be happy, successful, and caring people.
- Love the students always.

The Psychometrician

The Psychometrician must have the working knowledge of fundamental principles and methods of psychological testing and adhere to legal and professional ethical standards in the field of Psychological Testing. One must possess a clear and fluid speech, clerical skills for correcting and recording tests and their results accurately and technical writing skills for reporting test results

The main function of a psychometrician is the administration and interpretation of tests given to students. Specifically, psychometrician performs the following:

1. Carries out the developmental and administration of the testing program through preserving and preparing testing materials, administers individual and mass testing and providing those concerned with appropriate reports.
2. Conducts researches related to testing program and other school needs.
3. Takes charge of typing and maintenance of correspondence, subject and confidential personnel life.
4. Supervises and monitors the inventory and replenishment of supplies.
5. Keeps the Student Services Director be informed about the progress of the testing program, requisition and inventory activities and office file.
6. Submits a regular progress report to Student Services Director.
7. Maintains membership in appropriate professional organizations.
8. Coordinates to the Guidance Counselor.

The Guidance Staff

The Guidance Staff welcomes people and informs clients of the whereabouts of the Guidance Personnel, receives and transmits messages to the appropriate people, assists in checking and filing tests.

The guidance staff shall have the following functions:

1. Assists in typing and maintenance of correspondence, subject and confidential personal life.

2. Assists in maintaining and updating the collection of data.
3. Performs clerical jobs in relation to the implementation of guidance services.
4. Performs the inventory and replenishment of supplies.
5. Reports to the Guidance Counselor.
6. Performs extra tasks whenever deemed necessary.

The Peer Helpers

The Peer Helpers are interested students who has the potential to become good leaders and facilitators by teaching them the counseling and facilitating skills so as to be of service to other students who are in need. They undergo a series of training to equip them in assisting other students.

Criteria for the Selection of Peer Helpers:

1. Results of the interview based on the psychological tests taken
2. Academic performance and his relationship with others
3. Should be a DSSC student of any course
4. Commitment and faithfulness to serve
5. Must undergo the training modules.

They shall have the following functions:

1. Help facilitate the activities designed by the guidance office for the students' development such as seminars and trainings;
2. Actively participate in the monthly meetings conducted by the organization;
3. Report to the guidance office twice a week;
4. Attend monthly meeting;
5. Involve themselves in counseling with peers; and
6. Participate in the community outreach program.

Role of Faculty and Administrators in Guidance

Faculty

The faculty communicates with students on an almost daily basis, and is in a position to establish a relationship based on mutual trust and respect (Gibson and Mitchell, 1999):

1. Engages in adolescent study and diagnosis by understanding students' background and needs.
2. Identifies and refers students needing specialized assistance.
3. Contributes to educational and vocational planning needs of students through academic integration.
4. Assists students toward better adjustment whenever possible.
5. Contributes to and evaluate cumulative records of students.
6. Provides release time for counseling and testing activities.
7. Implements recommendations derived from the studies conducted by the office.
8. Provides recommendations to further develop the guidance services.

Administrators

- Establish, support, encourage, and acknowledge the Guidance Program and communicate program descriptions, accomplishments, and needs to the Board of Trustees, parents, faculty, personnel and students.

- Provide leadership in supporting the program through well-defined budget.
- Provide released time and group guidance activities in the class schedule.
- Assign staff as committee members for planning and evaluating the many aspects of school program.
- Provide leadership in the use of community resources.

Guidance Services

The DSSC guidance services include Orientation Service, Individual Inventory Services, Counseling Services, Information Services, Testing Services, Follow-up, Referral, and Evaluation.

Orientation Service

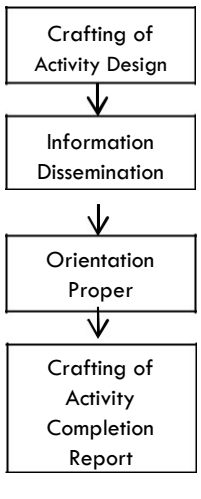
A regular comprehensive orientation is arranged for new, continuing, transferee and returnee students about the school policies, relevant laws, programs and activities for their awareness and guidance during their stay in the college.

Policies and Guidelines

The orientation service shall be carried out through the following:

a. First year, transferring and returning students shall be given basic knowledge about DSSC institution- its history, rules and regulations, programs and services for students, academic performance and retention policies, organizations and activities for the students.
a. Orientation program is to be conducted on the second week of classes in every semester.
b. Room to room orientation on school policies shall also be conducted every school year for continuing students through the assistance of the DSSC Peer Helpers and SSSG Officers.
c. Student handbook shall be given to the new students at the start ofevery school year.
d. Separate orientation for Persons with Disabilities and other students with special needs shall be conducted within the first month from the start of classes in every semester.

Procedure



1. Crafting of activity design for the conduct of orientation for freshmen, transferees and returnees for approval of the Vice President of the Academic Affairs.
2. Dissemination of information about the orientation thru the bulletin boards of the school and the official facebook pages of DSSC Student Services and DSSC Guidance Office.
3. Conduct of Orientation Program thru face to face or on-line mode. Attendance shall during orientation.
4. Crafting of activity completion report.

Individual Inventory Service

The Individual Inventory service consists of all information gathered about each student. The information is stored in a Cumulative Folder where the data

accumulated about each student are kept while the student is still in school and up to a few years after. It includes the entrance test results, student's information sheets and cumulative record and counselor's notation sheet. It is aimed to:

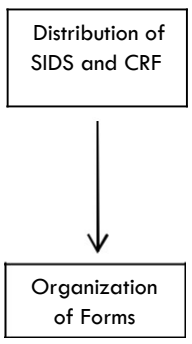
1. To allow students develop a deeper, fuller self awareness
2. To create appropriate plans for improving the quality of the student's life based on this awareness and self-understanding.

Policies and Guidelines

The following shall be carried out:

1. Records of students must be securely filed in an individual cumulative folder which include the following: (a) Student's Information Data Sheet, (b) Test Results in Raw Score and Percentile Ranks, (c) Confidential data, interview notes, special test results, private matters of home and family, personality traits, (d) Study Habit checklist, used, interpreted and filed, (e) Anecdotal Record, (f) call slip, and (g) counselor's notation sheet.
2. Records must be accessible to counselors concerned.
3. Information kept is strictly confidential.
4. Only authorized persons are allowed to borrow or look at the cumulative folders of students.

Procedure



1. GTC provides the Student Information Data Sheet (SIDS) and Cumulative Record Form (CRF) to be filled out by all new students upon admission to college; For continuing students, SIDS shall be filled out by them for updating of personal information upon counseling every school year.
2. The filled out forms shall be filed in the student's individual folders along with the Test results and other documents of each student.
3. The students' data folders shall be filed and kept in the cabinet for confidentiality.

Counseling Service

Counseling service is vital in helping an individual as he goes through the different phases in his life. It is designed to facilitate positive change in student behavior, feelings, and attitudes. Its objectives are the following:

- To assist individuals to make meaningful choices and effective decision.
- To help students know himself and his problems arrive at greater degree of assurance and self-direction so that he may act prudently in the events of his daily life.
- To render personal assistance in a manner that will develop the virtues, especially those of responsibility and self-control in a student who is forming himself socially, morally, spiritually and vocationally.
- To provide guidance in the gradual adjustment of students to new surroundings and to new period of life with its many accompanying problems.

❖ ***Counseling Considerations***

1. Gender Sensitive individual and group counseling shall be provided by a

licensed counselor. The acceptable ratio of counselor to student population is at least 1:1,000.
2. A counseling room shall be provided to ensure the privacy and confidentiality of counseling sessions. The records and/or counseling notes are maintained and kept confidential.
3. Appropriate and pro-active intervention programs and strategies may be adopted by HEIs to ensure that every student's need for guidance and counseling and psycho-social services may be provided in a timely manner.

Types of Counseling

1. Individual Counseling

Guidance counselor will spend significant amount of time working with individual in helping them focus on particular concerns such as making decisions about their future goals, current relationships and self-directions all throughout the school year.

2. Group Counseling

This session will help the students handle specific concerns or support with his peer with particular developmental goals.

3. Academic Counseling

This is put into service to students whose learning rate is slow or those who have advanced learning phase.

4. Career Counseling

This activity is designed to give students the opportunity for an effective and realistic career decision.

Policies and Guidelines in Counseling:

The following shall be strictly implemented to ensure effectiveness and efficiency of the service:

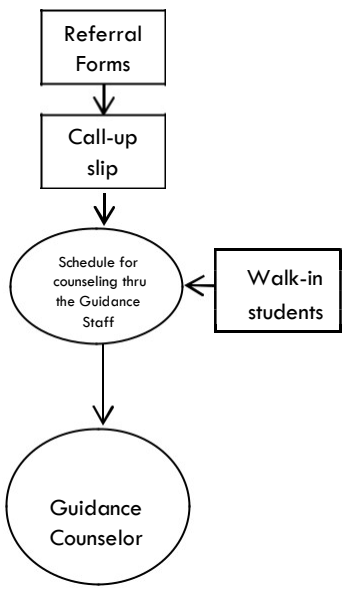
1. All counselors shall abide the ethical principles laid down by the counseling profession.
2. The counselor shall respect the integrity and safeguard the welfare of the person with whom he works.
3. The counselor shall refer cases beyond the competence if necessary to a specialist.
4. Counseling logbook shall be kept and maintained.
5. Counseling information shall be held in strictest confidentiality.
6. All counselors shall extend their services to any counselee regardless of course and year level.

Implementing Strategies

The Guidance Office shall provide *Counseling Referral Forms* in every institute in order for the teachers to refer students who need counseling . A *Call-Up Slip* will be issued to students who are referred and scheduled for counseling. Students may be pulled out from the class as permitted by the instructor, either in-group or in an individualized basis.

Electronic copies of Referral Forms and Call-Up Slips are also available for online referral and online counseling. Referrals can be done through sending a private message in the official Facebook page of *DSSC Student Services, DSSC Guidance Office* and *Facebook account of the Counselors.*

Procedure



1. The GTC provides Counselling Referral Forms to every institute to be distributed to all faculty members so that they can refer their students who need counselling. The faculty can also ask for an electronic copy of referral form from the GTC for online referral and online counselling.
2. A Call-Up Slip shall be issued to the referred student for counselling so that the student may be pulled out from class with the permission of the instructor. Schedules for Group counselling sessions are predetermined.
3. Walk-In students shall be accommodated by the Guidance Staff to be scheduled for counselling. The Guidance Counsellor may counsel the walk-in student upon arrival subject to urgency of the student's needs and the counselor's availability.
4. The Counselor allows the student to get comfortable and ready before the counselling starts. The Counselor informs and assures the student/counselee with the confidentiality of their conversation and explains the extent of confidentiality.
5. The student shall fill out the counselling session waiver form for follow-up sessions, log-in the Counselling logbook and answer the counselling evaluation form before leaving the office.

Frequency of Counseling

Students must be counseled at least once in a school year using the alphabetical listing in every course and year level.

Information Service

This service provides information available to the students of DSSC which can be classified into occupational, educational and personal-social. It is aimed to ensure positive growth for the total development of students through objective and workable program of activities through in-service trainings, seminars/symposia, fora and webinars.

Policies and Guidelines

1. The guidance counselor must coordinate with the department chairpersons in the preparation of the in-service training program and or webinars.
2. The department shall co-facilitate to the activity conducted by the guidance office.
3. The seminars, training and or webinars to be conducted must be compatible to the needs of the students and objectives of the school.

Types of Information

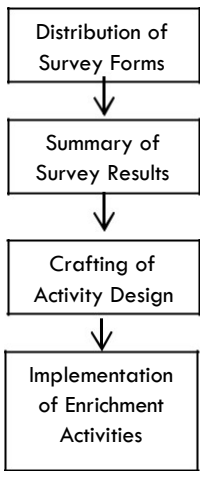
1. Educational Information
2. Social Information
3. Spiritual Information

4. Occupational Information
5. Psychological Information

Implementing Strategies

1. Survey and assess the needs of students
2. Analyze results and discuss with the department chairpersons and instructors
3. Propose activities that would respond to the needs expressed by the students
4. Monitor the effectiveness of the activities implemented.

Procedure



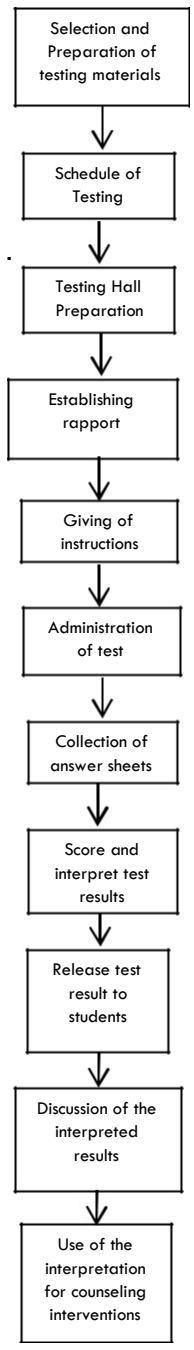
1. Survey and assessment needs of students shall be conducted by the GTC.
2. The information gathered from the survey and assessment needs of students shall be analyzed by the Guidance Counselor in coordination with the administrators and faculty members to identify appropriate enrichment activities for students.
3. GTC prepares the activity design for the enrichment activities to be approved by the VPAA.
4. The schedule of the activity shall then be posted in the school's bulletin boards and FB pages.
5. During the activity, students shall log in their names in the attendance sheet and shall answer the Activity Evaluation Sheet at the end of the activity.
6. Peer helpers assist the GTC personnel in facilitating the activity including registration of participants, activity evaluation and picture taking for documentation purposes.

<u>Testing Service</u>

This service includes the proper use of standardized test and inventories. These are test of mental ability, aptitude and achievement of the students. The information gathered from test results may be used for counselling and identify appropriate enrichment activities for students. The guidance office shall have a well-planned assessment program for students with appropriate standardized psychological test, administer, scored and interpreted by qualified personnel. The test results are interpreted to students, teachers and concerned individuals e.g. parents. It is aimed to:

a. Predict future performance to obtain a measure of ability, achievement and other characteristics that will offer a solid basis upon which individuals can make decision,
b. Diagnose students' problems and learning difficulties,
c. Assist administrators to make decisions in educational planning, determine strengths and weaknesses of the instructional program, and provide basis for group guidance counseling.

Procedure



1. Preparation

- Select and prepare test materials appropriate test materials ahead of time.
- Schedule dates for testing considering the convenience of examinees.
- Choose a comfortable place for testing.

2. Administration of Test

- Review of instruction for test manual.
- Administer the test at a given time after establishment of rapport with examinees.
- Ensure that examinees are in good condition to take the test.
- Make instructions very clear through reading aloud the instructions in the manual.
- Follow the same procedures for the next group of examinees.
- Request examinees who finished ahead of time to review answers, remain quiet, and wait for time dismissal.
- When the time is up, ask everybody to stop writing (especially for standardized instructions), close his or her booklets and pass the answer sheet first.
- Check if all testing materials are complete before dismissal.

3. Interpretation of Results

- Review and consult the Test Manual whenever necessary.
- Clarify/consult the competent staff as the need arises.
- Record on the test papers the accurate interpretation of results.
- Prepare report for test results.

4. Utilization of Results

- Interpret/discuss results (profile) and implication to the educators. Provide profile of interpreted materials.
- Use of results for individual counseling, group guidance and information service.
- The interpreter of results must be careful and accurate in presenting information.

Analysis for further Utilization of Results

- Analyze results statistically to see profiles of examinees and to provide comparison between groups.
- Prepare abstract of results.
- Discuss findings and implications with faculty and administration
- Make relevant recommendations

- Come up with plan of action/s or help initiate implementing recommendations made
- Evaluate outcome/s

Policies and Guidelines

1. The guidance office shall coordinate with the department chairman in the scheduling of the psychological tests.
2. There shall be a proper training to any guidance staff that handles or has entry in testing.
3. The interpreter of results must be careful and accurate in presenting information.
4. All test materials especially the manual and booklets must be secured to maintain confidentiality.
5. Test must be used with important purpose.
6. There should be a consideration made to re-schedule exam for those absent and students found not in good condition to take rest.
7. Only authorized persons are allowed to borrow any tests in the office.
8. Nobody in the staff should bring materials outside the office.

<u>Follow-up & Referral</u>

Follow-up service can determine the adequacy and sufficiency of the programs and services extended in meeting the needs of its clientele.

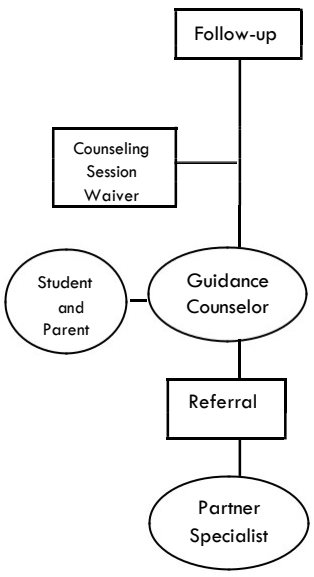
Referral refers to the assistance rendered to clients in obtaining services from other people or agencies that might be effective in helping them.

These are designed to:

1. Monitor the effectiveness of the guidance program in securing the basic information that is important for evaluating and planning the many phases of the school program, and
2. Render academic assistance and encouragement to students with academic problems.
3. Referral of cases to multi-disciplinary team of specialist to ensure that special needs of students are met.

Procedure

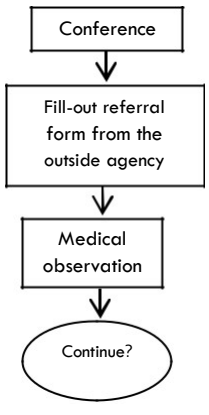
Follow-up



1. Students who have undergone counselling shall be scheduled for follow-up counselling session/s. The students shall fill-out the Counselling Session Waiver for the next schedule/session.
2. Students with special needs may be referred to the appropriate specialist who can help in meeting the student's needs.
3. If needed, the guidance counselor may conduct a conference with the parent/s of the concerned student explaining to them the need for referral and the important role parents play in helping and addressing the need of the student.
4. The Guidance counselor will coordinate and discuss history of the case with the specialist prior to referral.

5. The student together with the parent will be accompanied by the guidance counselor to the partner specialist.
6. The guidance counselor will conduct a constant follow-up with the progress of referral.

Referral for Assistance from Outside Agencies/Organization



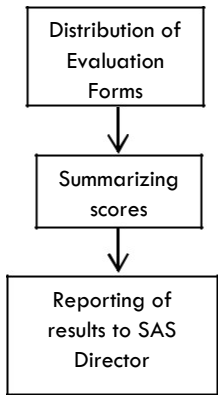
1. Students who needs professional help shall be referred to outside agencies/organizations.
2. A case conference shall be done by the guidance counselor together with the student's parents and the faculty involved.
3. A referral form the outside agency shall filled-out by the guidance counselor and/or involved faculty.
4. The professional's medical observation/prognosis will be used as a bases for the continuity of the student's studies.

<u>Evaluation</u>

Evaluation seeks to collect relevant information to determine whether program goals are met in terms of outcomes as basis for modification of the delivery of services. It requires systematic collection and analysis of data to determine the value of a program, its effectiveness, adequacy, efficiency. It is aimed to:

1. provide evidence of the positive impact of Guidance Programs and Counselling Services on students, faculty, parents and community.
2. identifies needs not met by the existing program
3. provides a basis for designing staff development and parent consultation program.

Procedure



1. At the end of every semester, GTC conducts Guidance Services evaluation by the students. They shall answer and accomplish the Evaluation form before the Student Services Director sign their clearance.
2. The answered evaluation sheets shall then be collected and all answers will be tallied and analyzed by the GTC Personnel.
3. The evaluation results shall be reported to the Director of Student Affairs and Services to be discussed with the administrators for the enhancement of the guidance program and services.